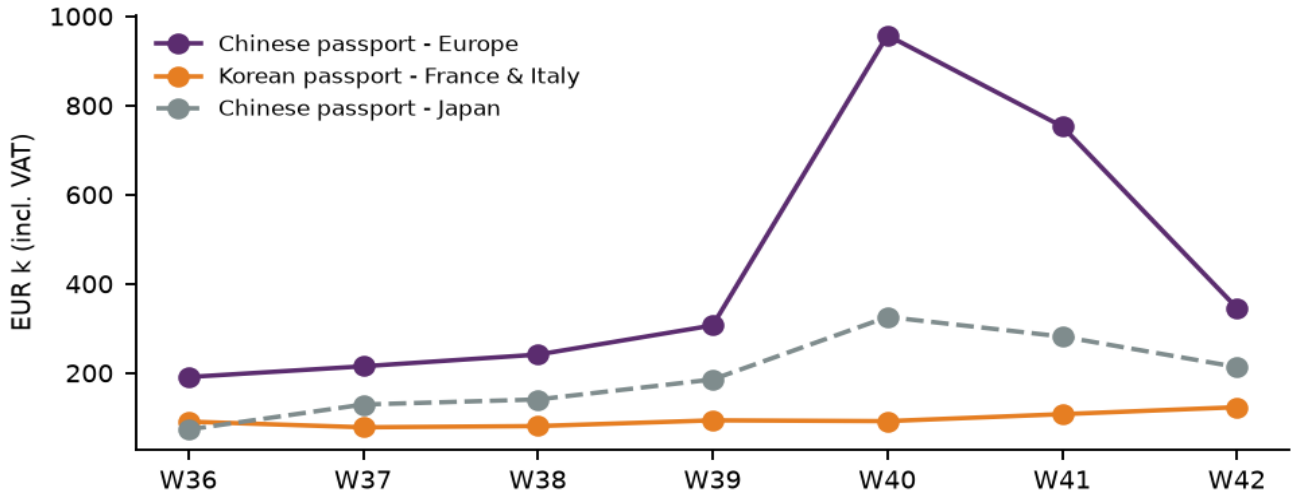
Tax free shopping at Valentino: September - mid October 2026

+10%

Korean shoppers' tax free spend at Valentino in France and Italy, weeks 39-40 vs weeks 36-37 (issued forms). After Chuseok (24-26 September) Korean travellers flocked to Paris and Milan.

+212%

Chinese shoppers' spend at Valentino in Europe during Golden Week (weeks 40-41) vs the two previous weeks. New direct flights from Chengdu and visa fast-track supported the strongest Golden Week since 2019.



Issued forms, spend incl. VAT, EUR. Week 43 excluded (partial).

Nationality (W40)	Forms	Spend EUR k	Share
China	547	1,595	48%
Other	203	469	14%
United States	135	296	9%
South Korea	61	139	4%
Japan	61	117	4%
Taiwan	54	116	4%
Saudi Arabia	58	91	3%
United Kingdom	42	68	2%

Market context (all luxury merchants, Aurelia network)

Destination	Nationality	Spend YoY Sep 26	Spend YoY 1-18 Oct 26
France	South Korea	+18%	+11%
Italy	South Korea	+14%	+9%
Italy	China	+6%	+31%
France	China	+4%	+24%
Switzerland	China	-3%	+12%
Japan	China	+21%	+17%
Japan	Taiwan	+9%	+12%
Germany	Gulf (GCC)	+2%	-4%
Spain	Latin America	+7%	+5%

- Korean spend in Europe accelerated after Chuseok; fashion & outerwear the fastest-growing category for Korean travellers.
- Chinese Golden Week 2026 spend in Europe was the highest since 2019 in our network (Milan and Paris leading).
- In Japan the weak yen keeps Chinese and Taiwanese spend elevated; we expect a peak before the 1 November price increases announced by several luxury houses.
- Average spend per form for Chinese shoppers in Italy: EUR 2,650 (luxury fashion), up 8% YoY.
- The UK is not covered (no VAT refund scheme for tourists since 2021).

Methodology: issued forms at the time of purchase; customs validation typically 70-85% of issued forms and lags 1-3 weeks. Spend includes VAT and is not net of refunds or cancellations. Week = Monday-Sunday. EUR at monthly ECB average.